

Unit 1: Mechanics and Materials

1.3 Mechanics

This topic covers rectilinear motion, forces, energy and power. It may be studied using applications that relate to mechanics such as sports.

This unit includes many opportunities for developing experimental skills and techniques by carrying out more than just the core practical experiments.

Candidates will be assessed on their ability to:

1	be able to use the equations for uniformly accelerated motion in one dimension: $s = \frac{(u+v)t}{2}$ $v = u + at$ $s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$ $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$
	Equations of Motion The equations of motion, a.k.a. the SUVAT equations, are a set of formulas used to describe the motion of an object undergoing constant acceleration (but not zero) and motion is in a straight line - These equations relate displacement (s), initial velocity (u), final velocity (v), acceleration (a), and time (t). - Here are the four primary equations of motion: 1. $v = u + at$: (when displacement is not given) 2. $s = ut + (1/2)at^2$: (when final velocity is not given) 3. $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$: (when time taken is not given) 4. $s = \frac{(u+v)t}{2}$: (when acceleration is not given) - It is important to note that the variables u, v, a and s are vector quantities so can be negative as well as positive depending on its direction - Time is a scalar quantity so will not be negative Useful tips! ○ Objects in motion often start or end at rest, making either u or $v = 0$ ○ Objects in freefall have a constant acceleration of 9.81 m/s^2 ○ When an object is slowing down it has a negative value for acceleration, this must be included in the calculation ○ Objects thrown or shot upwards also have negative acceleration (since they are slowing down as they ascend) and reach a final velocity of zero at the top of their path (at its maximum height)

2	be able to draw and interpret displacement-time, velocity-time and acceleration-time graphs
	Displacement-Time Graph - Gradient of graph = velocity - Area under graph is meaningless A curve means that the object is <i>accelerating</i> A straight diagonal line means that the object is moving with <i>constant velocity</i> A straight horizontal line (zero gradient) means that the object is <i>stationary</i> (not moving) A positive gradient represents motion in the positive direction A negative gradient represents motion in the negative direction A steep gradient means the object is moving at high constant velocity A flat horizontal line means the object is stationary (not moving) A curve with increasing gradient means the object is accelerating (can be at a constant or increasing rate depending on the shape of curve) A curve with increasing negative gradient means the object is in negative acceleration (speeding up back to point it started) A curve with decreasing positive gradient means the object is decelerating (slowing down)
	Velocity-Time Graph - Gradient = acceleration - Area under the curve = the displacement or distance travelled A curve indicates changing (non-uniform) acceleration A straight diagonal line represents uniform acceleration A straight horizontal line (zero gradient) represents motion with constant velocity A positive gradient represents an increase in velocity in the positive direction A negative gradient represents an increase in velocity in the negative direction A straight line with a positive gradient means object is travelling with constant positive acceleration A straight line at the bottom ($v = 0$) means that the object is stationary A flat straight horizontal line means that the object is moving with constant velocity (zero acceleration) A straight line with a negative gradient means object is accelerating in the negative direction at a constant rate (in this specific case, the object is said to be decelerating)

Acceleration-Time Graph

- Area under graph = change in velocity

A straight diagonal line

means that the object is accelerating at a constant changing rate

A straight horizontal line at the bottom ($a=0$)

(zero gradient) means that the object is

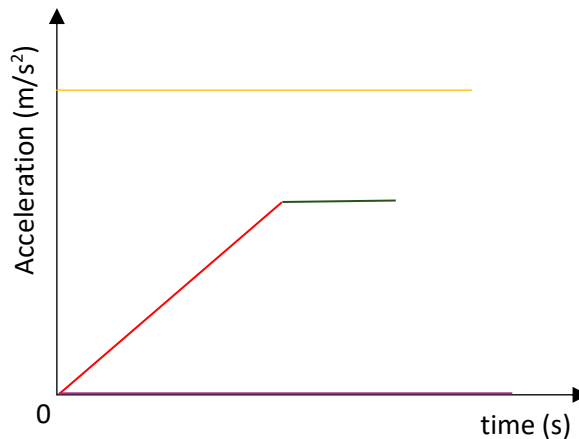
moving at constant velocity

A straight horizontal line (not at $a = 0$)

means that the object is moving at constant acceleration

A straight diagonal line means that the object is accelerating at a constant increasing rate

A straight horizontal line at the bottom ($a=0$) (zero gradient) means that the object is moving at constant velocity



A flat horizontal line means the object is at constant accelerating

A straight horizontal line that is not at $a = 0$ means the object is moving at constant acceleration

!Just to clear things up:

Negative acceleration and Deceleration are related but NOT exactly the same thing

Negative acceleration means acceleration in the opposite direction of chosen positive direction (i.e. when gradient of velocity-time graph is negative)

It can be both speeding up in the opposite direction or slowing down in the same direction

Meanwhile, Deceleration only means slowing down regardless of direction so deceleration can be said to be a specific case of negative acceleration

3

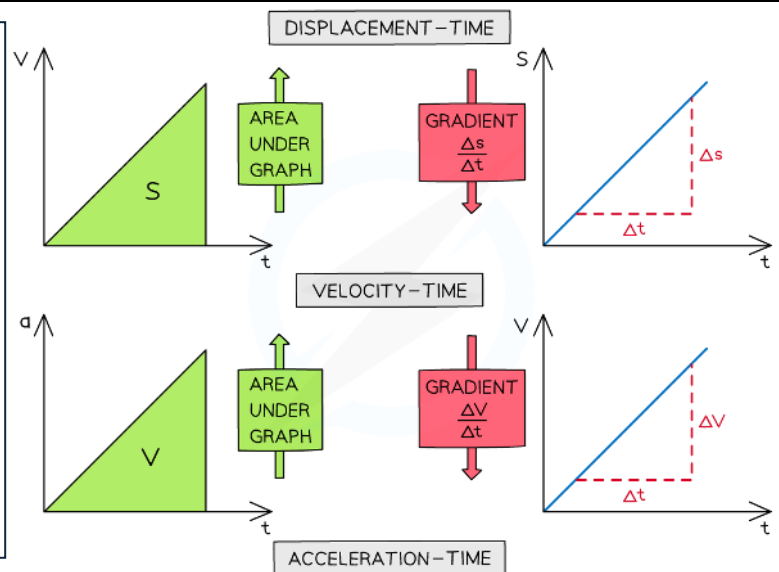
know the physical quantities derived from the slopes and areas of displacement-time, velocity-time and acceleration-time graphs, including cases of non-uniform acceleration and understand how to use the quantities

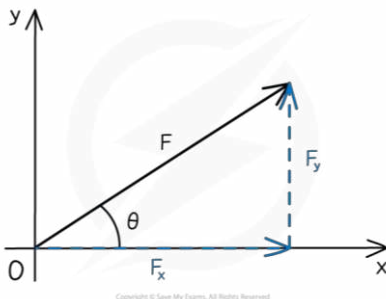
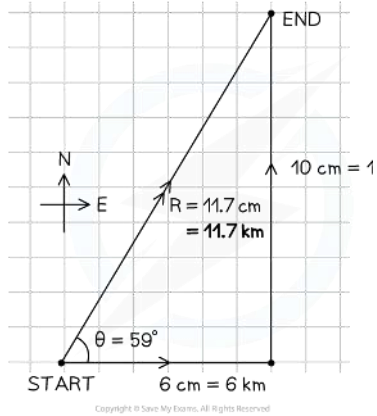
Cases of non-uniform acceleration

Non-uniform acceleration such as the free fall of a skydiver will produce a **curved** velocity-time graph.

To find out its gradient at a certain point or time, you'll have to draw a tangent at that point and calculate its gradient.

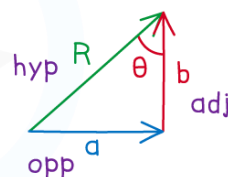
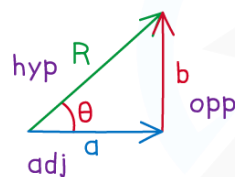
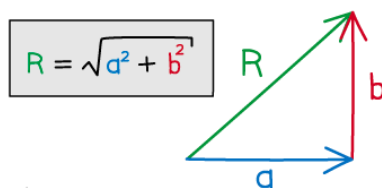
When drawing tangents, make it as long as possible!



4	understand scalar and vector quantities and know examples of each type of quantity and recognise vector notation																								
	Scalar quantities only have magnitude Vector quantities have both magnitude and direction <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Scalar</th><th>Vector</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Distance</td><td>Displacement</td></tr> <tr> <td>Speed</td><td>Velocity</td></tr> <tr> <td>Mass</td><td>Weight</td></tr> <tr> <td>Energy/ Work done</td><td>Force</td></tr> <tr> <td>Volume</td><td>Acceleration</td></tr> <tr> <td>Density</td><td>Momentum</td></tr> <tr> <td>Temperature</td><td>Moment</td></tr> <tr> <td>Power</td><td>Electric/ Gravitational field strength</td></tr> <tr> <td>Charge</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>Efficiency</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>Electric/ Gravitational potential</td><td></td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Scalar	Vector	Distance	Displacement	Speed	Velocity	Mass	Weight	Energy/ Work done	Force	Volume	Acceleration	Density	Momentum	Temperature	Moment	Power	Electric/ Gravitational field strength	Charge		Efficiency		Electric/ Gravitational potential	
Scalar	Vector																								
Distance	Displacement																								
Speed	Velocity																								
Mass	Weight																								
Energy/ Work done	Force																								
Volume	Acceleration																								
Density	Momentum																								
Temperature	Moment																								
Power	Electric/ Gravitational field strength																								
Charge																									
Efficiency																									
Electric/ Gravitational potential																									
5	be able to resolve a vector into two components at right angles to each other by drawing and by calculation																								
	Resolving Vectors by Scale Drawing - Choose a suitable scale which fits to the page - Draw the resultant vector with the correct length corresponding to its magnitude using a ruler and correct angle according to its direction using protractor - Draw a horizontal line from the tail of the resultant vector and then connect the head of this horizontal vector with the head of the resultant vector - The vector components must be perpendicular to each other Resolving Vectors by Calculation   Using trigonometry, the resultant vector F can be resolved into its components: For the horizontal component, $F_x = F \cos \theta$ For the vertical component, $F_y = F \sin \theta$																								
6	be able to find the resultant of two coplanar vectors at any angle to each other by drawing, and at right angles to each other by calculation																								
	Adding vectors at any angle by scale drawing Coplanar vectors are vectors that lie within the same plane TRIANGLE METHOD STEP 1: LINK THE VECTORS HEAD-TO-TAIL STEP 2: FORM THE RESULTANT VECTOR FROM LINKING THE TAIL OF a TO THE HEAD OF b $c = a + b$ PARALLELOGRAM METHOD STEP 1: LINK THE VECTORS TAIL-TO-TAIL STEP 2: COMPLETE THE RESULTING PARALLELOGRAM STEP 3: THE RESULTANT VECTOR IS THE DIAGONAL OF THE PARALLELOGRAM $c = a + b$																								

Adding vectors at right angles by calculation

- Finding the **direction** of the resultant using **trigonometry**
- Finding the **magnitude** of the resultant using **Pythagoras**

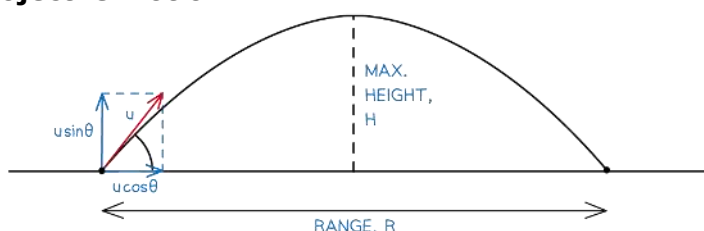


Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

7

understand how to make use of the independence of vertical and horizontal motion of a projectile moving freely under gravity

Projectile motion



VERTICAL MOTION (↑)

INITIAL SPEED, $u = u \sin \theta$

ACCELERATION, $a = 9.81 \text{ ms}^{-2}$

DISPLACEMENT = 0

TIME OF FLIGHT

$u = u \sin \theta$ $v = 0$ $a = -g$ $t = ?$

THE EQUATION THAT RELATES THESE QUANTITIES IS

$v = u + at$

$0 = u \sin \theta - gt$

$t = \frac{u \sin \theta}{g}$

$2t = \frac{2u \sin \theta}{g}$

IF THE TIME TO MAXIMUM HEIGHT IS t , THEN THE TIME OF FLIGHT IS $2t$

MAXIMUM HEIGHT ATTAINED

$u = u \sin \theta$ $v = 0$ $a = -g$ $H = ?$

THE EQUATION THAT RELATES THESE QUANTITIES IS

$v^2 = u^2 + 2as$

$0 = (u \sin \theta)^2 - 2gH$

$2gH = (u \sin \theta)^2$

$H = \frac{(u \sin \theta)^2}{2g}$

RANGE (R)

$u = u \cos \theta$ $t = \frac{2u \sin \theta}{g}$ $a = 0$ $R = ?$

THE EQUATION THAT RELATES THESE QUANTITIES IS

DISTANCE = SPEED × TIME

$R = (u \cos \theta)t$

$R = \frac{2u^2 \sin \theta \cos \theta}{g}$

$R = \frac{u^2 \sin 2\theta}{g}$

USING THE TRIG IDENTITY:

$2 \sin \theta \cos \theta = \sin 2\theta$

HORIZONTAL MOTION (→)

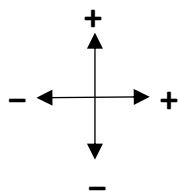
INITIAL SPEED, $u = u \cos \theta$

ACCELERATION, $a = 0$

DISPLACEMENT = R

Sign convention

You may choose any direction to be positive, so long as you are consistent with it in your calculations. So it is advised to add a label so that the examiner can clearly tell which direction you chose. Generally:



The trajectory of an object undergoing projectile motion can be resolved into a **vertical component** and a **horizontal component**

The time of flight is the same for both vertical and horizontal components (common t)

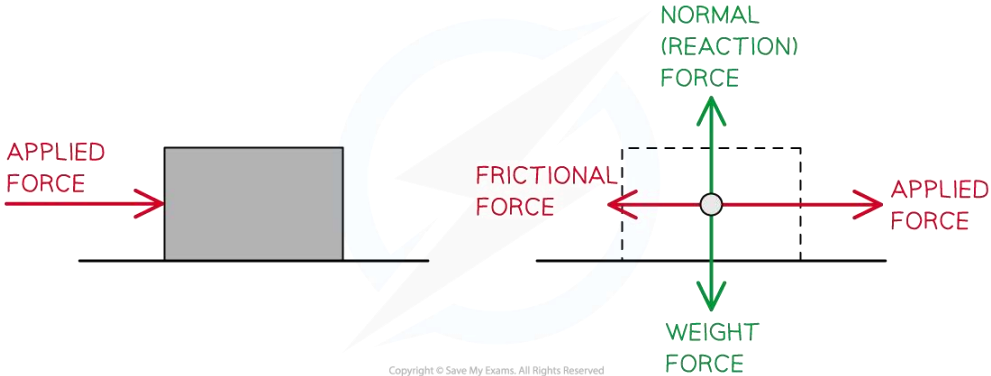
At maximum height, the projectile is momentarily at rest ($v = 0$)

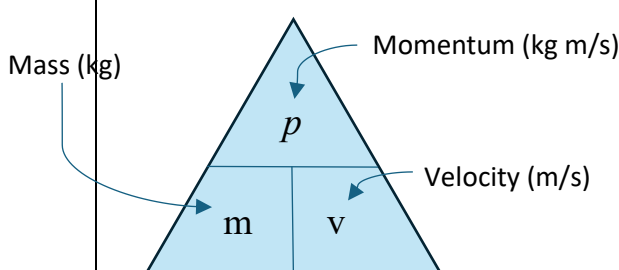
Range is the horizontal distance traveled by the projectile

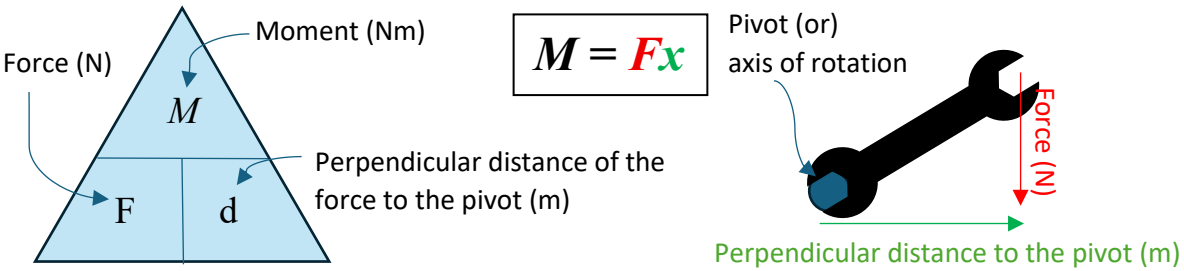
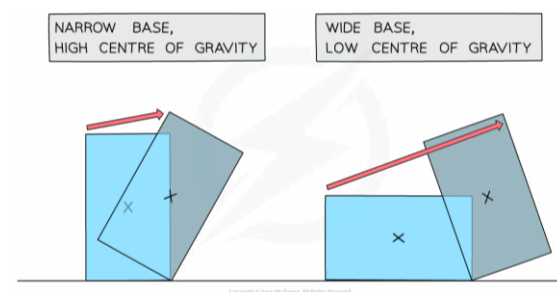
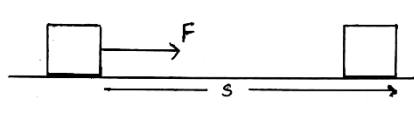
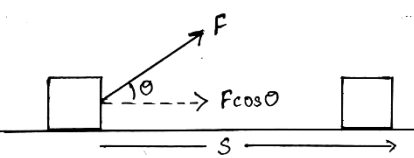
Sign Convention

Generally, we consider the direction the object is initially travelling in as positive

So all vectors in the direction of motion will be positive and opposing vectors, such as drag forces, will be negative

8	be able to draw and interpret free-body force diagrams to represent forces on a particle or on an extended but rigid body using the concept of <i>centre of gravity</i> of an extended body
	We can use a free-body diagram to represent forces acting on a particle or on an extended but rigid body (which simply means that all parts stay in the same position relative to each other when the object moves) You can draw a free-body diagram by drawing the centre of gravity (centre of mass) and drawing the forces acting on that body using vectors with correct direction and proportional length - Free body diagrams simplify problems by reducing complex shapes into simple one - Any object can be thought of as a particle (or a point mass)  Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved
9	be able to use the equation $\Sigma F = ma$, and understand how to use this equation in situations where m is constant (Newton's second law of motion), including Newton's first law of motion where $a = 0$, objects at rest or travelling at constant velocity <i>Use of the term 'terminal velocity' is expected.</i>
ΣF means sum of all forces acting on object	Newton's First Law (Law of Inertia) states that: "An object at rest will stay at rest and an object in motion will stay in motion with the same speed and direction unless acted upon by an unbalanced external force" - This means if the forces in any direction are balanced, then the resultant force ΣF is 0 - Hence, the acceleration is also 0 - Hence, the velocity is constant (or uniform) - The velocity (i.e. speed and direction) can only change if a resultant force acts on the object Newton's Second Law (Law of Force and Acceleration) states that: "The acceleration of an object is directly proportional to the net force acting on it and inversely proportional to its mass" This is expressed as the formula $\Sigma F = ma$ - If the resultant force is along the direction of motion, the body will speed up (accelerate) or slow down (decelerate) - If the resultant force is at an angle, the body will change direction Terminal Velocity On Earth, there is always some force that acts on objects in motion like friction Terminal velocity is reached when the forces in the direction of motion are balanced by the forces opposing motion .

10	be able to use the equations for gravitational field strength $g = \frac{F}{m}$ and weight $W = mg$
	NEWTON'S SECOND LAW $F = ma$ $\therefore a = \frac{F}{m}$ BY DEFINITION $W = mg$ and $g = \frac{F}{m}$ IN FREEFALL $F = W$ $\downarrow \quad \downarrow$ $\therefore ma = mg$ $\therefore a = g$  $a = 9.81 \text{ ms}^{-2}$ REGARDLESS OF WEIGHT Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved
11	CORE PRACTICAL 1: Determine the acceleration of a freely-falling object
12	know and understand Newton's third law of motion and know the properties of pairs of forces in an interaction between two bodies
	Newton's third law of motion states that: "Whenever two bodies interact, the force they exert on each other are equal in magnitude and opposite in direction" - All forces arise in <u>pairs</u> – If A exerts a force on B, then B exerts an equal and opposite force on A - Force pairs are of the <u>same type</u> – if A exerts a gravitational force, then B also exerts an equal and opposite gravitational force - <u>Two bodies</u> are exerting the same type of force on one another, not one body exerting two forces in opposite directions
13	understand that momentum is defined as $p = mv$
	Momentum  $p = mv$!Note that an object at rest has no momentum Momentum of an object will change if: - The object accelerates or decelerates - Changes direction - Mass changes
14	know the principle of conservation of linear momentum, understand how to relate this to Newton's laws of motion and understand how to apply this to problems in one dimension
	Law of conservation of linear momentum states that: "The total momentum before a collision = the total momentum after a collision provided no external force acts (i.e. in an isolated/closed system)"

15	be able to use the equation for the moment of a force, moment of force = Fx where x is the perpendicular distance between the line of action of the force and the axis of rotation
Don't forget to take components if the given length is not perpendicular to the force applied	Moment  Force (N) Moment (Nm) $M = Fx$ Pivot (or) axis of rotation Perpendicular distance of the force to the pivot (m) Perpendicular distance to the pivot (m) Moment is defined as: The turning effect of a force about a pivot (in Nm)
16	be able to use the concept of centre of gravity of an extended body and apply the principle of moments to an extended body in equilibrium
	Centre of gravity (centre of mass) is defined as: "The point through which the weight of an object acts" - For a symmetrical object of uniform density, the centre of gravity is located at the point of symmetry - For an irregular object, its centre of gravity is found by locating its balance point !Note that centre of gravity can lie inside or outside of a body Stability An object is stable when its centre of gravity lies above its base The wider base an object has, the lower its centre of gravity and it is more stable The narrower base an object has, the higher its centre of gravity and the object is more likely to topple over if pushed  Principle of moments states that: "For an object in equilibrium, sum of clockwise moment about a point = sum of anti-clockwise moment about the same point"
17	be able to use the equation for work $\Delta W = F\Delta s$, including calculations when the force is not along the line of motion
	Work is defined as: "The amount of energy transferred when an external force causes an object to move over a certain distance"  If the force applied is parallel to the direction of motion: $W = F\cos\theta s = Fs$  If the force applied is at an angle θ to the direction of motion: $W = F\cos\theta s$

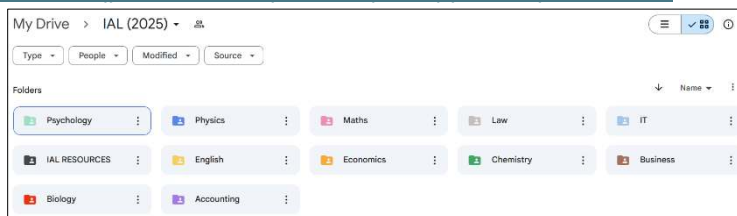
18	be able to use the equation $E_k = \frac{1}{2} mv^2$ for the kinetic energy of a body
	Kinetic energy (E_k or KE) is the energy an object has due to its motion (or velocity) This means the faster an object moves, the greater its kinetic energy Formula derivation of $KE = \frac{1}{2} mv^2$ $W = F \times s$ $= ma \times \frac{v^2 - u^2}{2a}$ $W = \frac{1}{2} m (v^2 - u^2)$ If $u = 0$, (object starts at rest) $W = \frac{1}{2} mv^2$ Work done = Change in kinetic energy $\therefore E_k = \frac{1}{2} mv^2$
19	be able to use the equation $\Delta E_{grav} = mg\Delta h$ for the difference in gravitational potential energy near the Earth's surface
	Gravitational potential energy (E_{grav} or GPE) is the energy stored in a mass due to its position in a gravitational field ○ If a mass is lifted up, it will gain GPE (converted from other forms of energy) ○ If a mass falls, it will lose GPE (and be converted to other forms of energy) GPE near the Earth's surface where it is uniform has the equation $\Delta E_{grav} = mg\Delta h$ Formula derivation of $GPE = mg\Delta h$ CONSIDER A MASS m LIFTED THROUGH HEIGHT h THE WEIGHT OF THE MASS IS mg WHERE g IS THE GRAVITATIONAL FIELD STRENGTH  $W = F \times d = mg \times \Delta h$ DUE TO ITS NEW POSITION, THE BODY IS NOW ABLE TO DO EXTRA WORK EQUAL TO $mg\Delta h$ CHANGE IN POTENTIAL ENERGY = $mg\Delta h$
20	know, and understand how to apply, the principle of conservation of energy including use of work done, gravitational potential energy and kinetic energy
	The Principle of Conservation of Energy states that: "Energy can neither be created nor destroyed, it can only be transferred from one store to another" This means the total energy input should always be equal to the total energy output • Conservation of energy is often applied in questions about exchanges between kinetic energy and gravitational potential energy Example:

21	be able to use the equations relating power, time and energy transferred or work done $P = E/t$ or $P = W/t$
1 Watt = 1 J/s	Power is defined as: "The rate of doing work" (or) "The rate of transfer of energy" "The work done per unit time" (or) "The energy transfer per unit time" $P = W/t$ $P = E/t$
22	be able to use the equations $\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful energy output}}{\text{total energy input}}$ and $\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful power output}}{\text{total power input}}$
	Efficiency is defined as: "The ratio of the useful power OR energy transfer output from a system to its total power or energy transfer input" Efficiency has no units as it is a ratio and the units on the numerator and denominator cancel each other out $\text{EFFICIENCY} = \frac{\text{USEFUL POWER OUTPUT}}{\text{TOTAL POWER INPUT}} \times 100\%$ $\text{EFFICIENCY} = \frac{\text{USEFUL ENERGY OUTPUT}}{\text{TOTAL ENERGY INPUT}} \times 100\%$

Remarks

- Disclaimer: This Self-Study Booklet series are NOT intended as a textbook replacement but instead are meant to be used alongside it
- This booklet is primarily exam-based and has been produced to remove unnecessary information from the book to make it into a simpler and more compact form factor
- You are encouraged to regularly check the google drive for updated versions of this booklet (This means if you have downloaded it at a certain point in time, you should check the drive 3 or 4 months later to see if it has been updated with a new one or not)
- Thank you all for using this Self-Study Booklet and if you would like to find more resources like this one, do check out this google drive:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1qpY-sGR9iinJbnquB53hx8pLk49pyxd1?usp=drive_link
- You will be redirected here:

(Note that there are only Self-Study Booklets and CAQs for Physics and Chemistry, NOT Biology)



- Do keep in mind that this is still a work-in-progress and you are welcome to add more resources to it- just drop a text at @aeth_en on discord!

Importance notice regarding Usage Rights

- There are certain images and illustrations used in this document that have been sourced from many different sources. The ownership of these images and/or illustrations belong to their rightful owners
- I do not own these images and/or illustrations
- Reprinting or Copying of this document and Selling/ Profiting will NOT be tolerated
- This Self-Study Booklet is intended for students worldwide studying for the Edexcel International A-Levels and will remain free of charge indefinitely

Help us improve

- This booklet is in its first edition so it may contain mistakes here and there
- Please let us know of any room for improvement so that we can make it better!
- Contact: mth.2021education@gmail.com or @aeth_en on discord
- Best of luck in your A-Levels journey!!